VOL. I WEEKDAY EDITION

THE SPACEX DISPATCH

Weekday briefing on SpaceX launches, Starlink, AI and the SPCX stock

TUESDAY, OCTOBER 20, 2026 MARKET DATA AS OF MON OCT 19 CLOSE

THE MORNING PICTURE

Starfall flies again on results day

A Falcon 9 lifted off from Cape Canaveral at 7:04 a.m. EDT Tuesday with Bandwagon-5, a rideshare of 32 payloads that includes the second flight of SpaceX's Starfall return capsule, a day late because of recovery weather. The booster landed on the drone ship A Shortfall of Gravitas, and payload deployments began about an hour after launch (SpaceX).

After the close, SpaceX reports its third quarter, its second report as a public company. Musk's pledged share for every American child will go through Trump Accounts, President Trump said Monday, The Verge reported. SPCX rose 1.32% to $147.96 on Monday.

TODAY · Q3 EARNINGS

Third-quarter results after the close

Tue Oct 20 · results after the close · audio-only webcast 4:30 p.m. EDT

The webcast will also stream on X (SpaceX). Bloomberg's consensus as reported by Yahoo Finance calls for $12.7 billion in revenue, up from $7.8 billion in the second quarter, adjusted earnings of 15 cents a share and adjusted EBITDA (earnings before interest, taxes, depreciation and amortization) of $6.59 billion; the Connectivity segment, which includes Starlink, is expected to earn $1.66 billion on $4.45 billion in revenue, after second-quarter Connectivity revenue rose 66% to $4.3 billion, Reuters noted. LSEG data show $12.74 billion and 14 cents, according to Reuters, and Yahoo Finance's own tally is 16 cents on $13.00 billion. Investors are watching AI spending, which reached $15.8 billion in the second quarter, and new annual recurring revenue (ARR) figures; last month Chief Financial Officer Bret Johnsen indicated SpaceX would reach $100 billion in ARR by year-end. Under the prospectus, up to 1.3 billion more locked-up Class A shares, 28% of those under the 180-day lock-up, become sellable on the second full trading day after the results: Thursday, October 22.

I · LAUNCHES

Bandwagon-5 carries a second Starfall

The capsule is meant to bring experiments and products made in orbit back to Earth.

"Starfall enables affordable, routine access to a microgravity environment, providing unique opportunities for on-orbit manufacturing, scientific research, and testing," SpaceX posted minutes before launch. The capsule debuted on June 23; this time it rides with 31 customer payloads, among them Varda Space Industries' W-Series 7 capsule and Planet's Pelican-12 imaging satellite, and is the last to separate, about 2 hours 48 minutes after liftoff, Space.com reported. The FAA's environmental assessment describes Starfall as about 3.1 meters wide and 2,100 kilograms, able to return up to 1,000 kilograms.



A Falcon 9 lifts off from Space Launch Complex 40 at Cape Canaveral with Crew-12 on Feb. 13, 2026. Bandwagon-5 flew from the same pad on Tuesday.
PHOTO: NASA/CORY S. HUSTON · PUBLIC DOMAIN

The first stage, on its 19th flight, landed about nine minutes after launch. The launch had been postponed from Monday for

poor weather in the recovery zone, Spaceflight Now lists, and on Tuesday the launch time moved from 6:30 to 7:04 a.m. EDT (Spaceflight Now). SpaceNews also covered the launch.

II · UPCOMING FLIGHTS

A Starlink launch tonight, Starship in November

Every SpaceX launch on the books for the next two months, with how firm each date is and where it comes from. Times are Eastern: EDT through November 1, EST after.

DATE / TIME (EDT/EST)	VEHICLE	MISSION	PAD	STATUS	SOURCES
Tue Oct 20, 7:10 p.m. EDT	Falcon 9	Starlink 15-15, 27 V2 Mini satellites; booster B1063, 36th flight; drone ship Of Course I Still Love You	SLC-4E, Vandenberg	Tentative	Launch Library 2; Spaceflight Now
Sat Oct 24, 1:29 a.m. EDT	Falcon 9	Starlink 15-16	SLC-4E, Vandenberg	Tentative	Launch Library 2
Wed Oct 28, 12:31 a.m. EDT	Falcon 9	Starlink 15-18	SLC-4E, Vandenberg	Tentative	Launch Library 2
Thu Nov 5, 5:34 p.m. EST	Falcon 9	NROL-195, National Reconnaissance Office	SLC-4E, Vandenberg	Tentative	Launch Library 2
NET Nov 8	Starship	Flight 15, Ship 42 and Booster 22; booster and ship catches planned	Pad 2, Starbase, Texas	Preliminary	NASASpaceflight (unofficial)
NET Nov 10	Falcon 9	Starlink 15-21	SLC-4E, Vandenberg	Preliminary	Launch Library 2
NET Nov 30	Falcon 9	Cygnus NG-25 cargo to the ISS	SLC-40, Cape Canaveral	Preliminary	Launch Library 2
December	Starship	Flight 16, likely Ship 43 and Booster 23	Possibly LC-39A, Kennedy	Preliminary	NASASpaceflight (unofficial)

Status: Confirmed means the operator or NASA has announced the date and time. Tentative means a specific date appears in published schedules but has not been confirmed by SpaceX or its customer. Preliminary means only a no-earlier-than (NET) date or month, or an unofficial target. Changes since Monday's issue: Bandwagon-5 flew Tuesday at 7:04 a.m. EDT after slipping a day for recovery-zone weather and moving its launch time from 6:30 a.m. (Spaceflight Now). Starlink 15-15 now shows 7:10 p.m. EDT in Launch Library 2, while Spaceflight Now still lists a window opening at 6:14 p.m.; no reason has been given. Newly listed: Starlink 15-18, NROL-195 and Starlink 15-21. Pads: Space Launch Complex 4 East (SLC-4E), Space Launch Complex 40 (SLC-40), Launch Complex 39A (LC-39A).

Starship Flights 15 and 16

Flight 15 is targeting November 8, with the goal of catching both Booster 22 and Ship 42; Ship 42's engines were removed for an extra cryogenic test, and Booster 22 is waiting to roll to Pad 2 for a static fire, NASASpaceflight reported. Musk has said the flight should come before Thanksgiving. Flight 16, likely Booster 23 and Ship 43, is aimed at December and could be the first Starship launch from Launch Complex 39A in Florida. Morgan Stanley's Adam Jonas thinks a catch of the ship on one of the two flights is possible, Yahoo Finance noted.

III · STARLINK

Europe's big four carriers team up on satellite spectrum

Deutsche Telekom, Orange, Telefónica and Vodafone may bid together for direct-to-device airwaves.

The four operators signed a letter of intent on Monday to explore a joint bid for 2 GHz mobile satellite service (MSS) spectrum, which the European Commission is preparing to reassign, with the satellites to come from "a satellite partner still to be selected," Via Satellite reported. The letter does not replace existing partnerships; Deutsche Telekom was the first partner signed for SpaceX's second-generation Starlink Mobile service, and SpaceX now owns EchoStar spectrum that holds one of the current European MSS licenses, Via Satellite noted.



A string of Starlink satellites crosses the night sky over the town hall in Tübingen, Germany, on April 24, 2020.
PHOTO: DKTUE / WIKIMEDIA COMMONS · CC0 (CROPPED)

"Europe's operators want to avoid becoming effectively MVNOs [mobile virtual network operators] for satellite coverage, selling somebody else's service on somebody else's terms," Ookla analyst Luke Kehoe told Via Satellite. "Starlink's push into the U.S. mobile market makes that concern harder to ignore." Bloomberg Law framed the group as a way to fend off SpaceX.

The move mirrors AT&T, T-Mobile and Verizon, which formed a joint venture for direct-to-device service earlier this month and called for competition among satellite providers, Via Satellite noted. Vodafone is a longtime partner and investor in AST SpaceMobile, which said it "welcomes" the letter. "The sovereignty claim will also be tested in the satellite contract itself," Kehoe said. "European spectrum rights and ground infrastructure only go so far when a separate partner controls the constellation."

QUICK HIT

Eleven million. "In the last year, Starlink Mobile has connected more than 11 million people across @VEONGroup 3 key markets: Ukraine, Kazakhstan, and Bangladesh," Starlink posted at 9:09 p.m. EDT Monday.

IV · SHAREHOLDERS

The share gift goes through Trump Accounts

Seventy-two million shares would be worth about $10.5 billion at Friday's price.

President Trump announced Monday afternoon that Musk's SpaceX shares for children will be given through Trump Accounts, the tax-advantaged accounts for kids, after Musk thanked Brad Gerstner for "helping enable this," The Verge reported. The White House has said over 70 million accounts were created after some 60 million children were enrolled automatically; Michael and Susan Dell, Ray and Barbara Dalio, Gerstner and SpaceX President Gwynne Shotwell have also promised contributions.

"Yes, giving shares, which are stakes in the future economy, directly to the people is the way," Musk replied to a follower at 11:58 a.m. EDT Monday; his thanks to Gerstner came in a separate reply. Asked overnight that the accounts' default investment option no longer be State Street, he answered "Noted."

The unlock calendar

Thursday's release of up to 1.3 billion Class A shares, 28% of those under the 180-day lock-up, is followed by up to 328.4 million (7%) on Saturday, October 24, and the rest on December 8: up to 328.4 million shares, or 797.6 million if the "Additional Release Shares" were not freed after the first earnings report, according to the prospectus. A separate group of about 7.8 billion shares, about 60% of those outstanding after the offering and including all of Musk's, is locked longer: up to 351.9 million unlock after the fourth-quarter report, and Musk's shares are held until the 366th day after the offering with no early release.

V · AI & COMPUTE

The question hanging over the results: financing

SpaceXSI lost $1.26 billion in the second quarter as AI spending doubled.

The AI unit, now called SpaceXSI, posted a second-quarter operating loss of $1.26 billion, against estimates of $2.39 billion, while AI spending rose to $15.8 billion from $7.7 billion in the first quarter, Yahoo Finance reported. "Need for additional financing remains a key overhang for sentiment, especially given the recent neocloud debt saga," Morgan Stanley's Adam Jonas wrote Monday; he models debt issuance of $60 billion, $80 billion and $90 billion in 2027, 2028 and 2029.

Evercore ISI expects SpaceX to exit 2026 at an annualized revenue run-rate of about $104 billion, with the AI segment doing "most of the heavy lifting," and estimates capital spending of about $151 billion in 2027, Reuters reported. "In terms of metrics, it would have to be Starlink revenue growth more than launch counts," said Shawn Campbell, an adviser at Camelthorn Investments who owns shares in SpaceX and Tesla.

QUICK HIT

Faster feeds. Musk announced two changes to X's timeline recommendations Monday night: a new ranking model that better predicts time spent and a retrieval model trained to surface posts people read to the end. Rewriting the X Android app "was also a big deal," he added.

Musk also promoted Grok Bot, the company's AI agent, writing that it "might turn out to be your favorite employee" (post), and answered John Carmack: "Grok's engineering analysis is good" (post).

Quiet before the report

No new SEC filings or FAA Federal Register notices since Monday's issue.

SEC

> No filings for Space Exploration Technologies Corp. (CIK 0001181412) were accepted on the SEC's Electronic Data Gathering, Analysis, and Retrieval system (EDGAR) between 8:00 a.m. EDT Monday and 8:45 a.m. EDT Tuesday. Latest insider filings:

Form 4/A · Sep 30 · Antonio Gracias, director — Amends his report of the September 11 in-kind distribution of 42,790,223 shares by Valor entities; 460,624,307 shares afterward. Filing

Form 4 · Sep 24 · Gwynne Shotwell, President and Chief Operating Officer — Exercised options for 342,170 shares on September 22 and sold the same number at weighted-average prices of $151.15 to $154.72; 2,472,035 shares afterward. Filing

FAA

Notice of intent · Oct 14 — The FAA is preparing a Programmatic Environmental Impact Statement (PEIS) on SpaceX's proposal to increase Starship-Super Heavy operations at Starbase (docket FAA-2026-12808); comments are due November 30. Phase 1 would allow 100 launches a year at any hour and Phase 2 up to 456, against a current limit of 25, and even Phase 1 is not expected for at least a year, NASASpaceflight noted. Federal Register



The launch tower's arms catch a Super Heavy booster at Starbase, Texas, during Starship's fifth flight test on Oct. 13, 2024. The FAA's new review covers a big increase in Starship operations at the site.
PHOTO: STEVE JURVETSON / WIKIMEDIA COMMONS · CC BY 2.0 (CROPPED)

FCC

800 MHz purchase — The roughly $8 billion deal for Grain's 800 MHz licenses needs FCC approval, Reuters noted.

Oct 29 · Open meeting — Votes on more spectrum for Supplemental Coverage from Space and a proposed 25 MHz auction. Broadband Breakfast

Nov 4 · Surety bond — Due under the October 6 order granting 15,000 Gen2 direct-to-device satellites in part. Exterra

Takeaways

1. SpaceX reports Q3 after Tuesday's close; the webcast is at 4:30 p.m. EDT.
2. Analysts expect about $12.7 billion in revenue and 15 cents a share.
3. Bandwagon-5 launched with the second Starfall capsule.
4. Musk's share gift will go through Trump Accounts.
5. Up to 1.3 billion locked-up shares can be sold from Thursday.

SOURCES

Posts by @SpaceX, @Starlink, @SpaceflightNow and @elonmusk on X; SpaceX, Spaceflight Now, Launch Library 2, NASASpaceflight, Space.com, SpaceNews, FAA, Federal Register, Deutsche Telekom; Reuters, Yahoo Finance, The Verge, Via Satellite, Bloomberg Law, Broadband Breakfast, Exterra; SEC EDGAR; Yahoo Finance via yfinance; CBOE. Photos: NASA (public domain); Wikimedia Commons (Dktue, CC0; Steve Jurvetson, CC BY 2.0).

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Up 1.3% ahead of the results

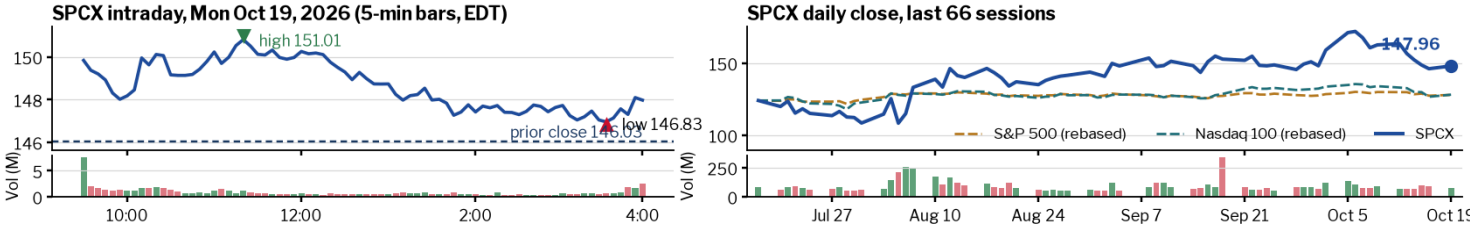
SPCX peaked late in the morning and gave back some of the gain as the Nasdaq rose 1.11% on a rebound in AI stocks, Reuters reported.

CLOSE	CHANGE	OPEN	DAY HIGH	DAY LOW
$147.96	**+$1.93**	**$149.23**	**$151.01**	**$146.83**
Mon Oct 19, 4:00 p.m. EDT	*+1.32% vs $146.03*	*regular session*	*11:20 a.m. EDT bar*	*3:30 p.m. EDT bar*
VOLUME	**RANGE SINCE IPO**	**MARKET CAP**	**5-DAY / 1-MONTH**	**SINCE LISTING**
73.75M	**$105–$226**	**$1.95T**	**−9.46% / −3.11%**	**+9.6%**
−20.0% vs 30-session avg 92.14M	*no 52-week history (listed Jun 12)*	*13.18B Class A+B shares × close; $2.01T with Cursor shares*	*5 and 21 sessions*	*vs $135 IPO price; −8.07% vs first close*

SINCE IPO, OCT 19

low $104.83 · Aug 3 — close $147.96 — high $225.64 · Jun 16

50-day avg $148.44



As of close Oct 19, 2026; times EDT. Source: Yahoo Finance via yfinance (regular session, unadjusted). Dashed navy = prior close; triangles = session high/low; volume green/red = up/down vs prior bar; index lines rebased to the first close shown.

RELATIVE PERFORMANCE, AS OF OCT 19 CLOSE

TICKER	1-DAY	5-DAY	1-MONTH	SINCE JUN 12
SPCX	**+1.32%**	**−9.46%**	**−3.11%**	**−8.07%**
S&P 500	+0.41%	−1.49%	+0.53%	+3.49%
Nasdaq 100	+1.17%	−3.70%	−0.39%	−0.36%
RKLB	+1.02%	−21.84%	−20.46%	−49.84%
ASTS	+2.98%	−18.64%	−28.45%	−49.19%
IRDM	+0.96%	−6.14%	−5.54%	−6.64%

OPTIONS (CBOE, TUE OCT 20, 8:35 A.M. EDT)

EXPIRY	CALL OI	PUT OI	P/C	ATM IV	TOP CALL / PUT
Oct 21	50,719	40,595	0.80	120.1%	$155 / $135
Oct 23	153,430	152,516	0.99	96.2%	$170 / $140
Oct 26	9,226	5,674	0.62	76.6%	$150 / $144
All expiries	**2,166,527**	**2,292,225**	**1.06**		**30-day IV index 57.3**

ANALYST CONSENSUS · OCT 20

Strong buy	8
Buy	22
Hold	5
Sell	3
Strong sell	0
Mean (1 = strong buy)	1.79
Mean target (31 analysts)	$222.71 (+50.5%)
Median target	$225.00
High / low target	$450.00 / $118.00

SHORT INTEREST & OWNERSHIP

Short interest, Sep 30	181.00M
Change vs. prior report	+4.2%
Short % of float	2.71%
Days to cover	2.01
Held by insiders	12.73%
Held by institutions	48.67%
Alphabet, Jun 30	7.16%
Valor Management, Jun 30	6.54%

VALUATION & TREND · OCT 19 CLOSE

Trailing P/E (EPS −$1.10)	—
Forward P/E (EPS est. $2.05)	72.2
Price/sales (rev. $23.04B)	84.6
Beta	—
50-day average	$148.44 (−0.3%)
200-day average	—
Q3 EPS est. (17 analysts)	$0.16
Q3 revenue est. (18)	$13.00B

RECENT RATING ACTIONS

DATE	FIRM	RATING	TARGET
Oct 16	Evercore ISI	Outperform	$230 to $275
Oct 9	Barclays	Overweight (initiated)	$254
Oct 9	TD Cowen	Buy	$200
Oct 7	Susquehanna	Neutral	$144 to $173
Sep 30	Macquarie	Outperform	$250
Sep 28	Deutsche Bank	Buy	$235
Sep 28	CLSA	Outperform (initiated)	$250

CATALYST CALENDAR

DATE	EVENT
Tue Oct 20	**Q3 results after close; webcast 4:30 p.m. EDT**
Wed Oct 21	Tesla Q3 results; webcast 5:30 p.m. EDT
Thu Oct 22	**Lock-up release: up to 1.3B more shares**
Sat Oct 24	Lock-up tranche: up to 328.4M more
Thu Oct 29	FCC open meeting: direct-to-device spectrum votes
Wed Nov 4	FCC surety-bond deadline (15,000 satellites)
Mon Nov 30	FAA Starbase PEIS scoping comments due
Tue Dec 8	180-day lock-up ends

Prices and averages: Yahoo Finance via yfinance (unadjusted; 30-session average excludes Oct 19). Consensus, targets, ratings, short interest (Sep 30), ownership (Jun 30, % of Class A) and estimates: Yahoo Finance, retrieved Tue Oct 20, 8:44 a.m. EDT. P/E is price to earnings per share (EPS); price/sales uses trailing 12-month revenue. Dashes: not yet meaningful (negative EPS; listed Jun 12). Options: CBOE delayed quotes; open interest (OI) and IV as of Monday's close; P/C is put/call by OI; ATM IV at the $148 strike. Shares: 10-Q cover (7,696,293,669 Class A + 5,485,486,276 Class B, Jul 28); $2.01T adds 391,041,680 Cursor merger shares (8-K). IPO price and lock-ups: prospectus (424B4). FCC dates: Exterra, Broadband Breakfast.